AMAY KATARIA

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SUMMARY

Performance-driven Technical Artist building custom workflows that integrate shader development and procedural worldbuilding using Unreal Blueprints. Seeking roles to streamline traditional pipelines through AI / ML integration.

Technical & Data Skills

3D & Technical Art	Unreal Engine (Blueprints) • Blender • Shader Development (GLSL / HLSL) • Spline
Development	Python • Node.js • C++ (Unreal) • Typescript • PostgreSQL
AI / ML Pipelines	ComfyUI • Stable Diffusion • Fine-Tuning / Unsloth • OpenAI SDK • Claude Code (Agentic)
Creative Coding	GLSL • Open Frameworks • P5.js • Processing
Design & Prototyping	Meshy • Genie • Figma • After Effects • Photoshop / Illustrator

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Extended Art Studio — **Chicago, IL**

Founder & Chief Creative Technologist — 2019 - Present

- Leading and managing a creative technology studio that delivers immersive experiences using cutting-edge technologies.

➢ ***Samsara*** *(documentation, GitHub)* — 2025 - 2026

- Engineered a **parametric Blueprint system** to procedurally arrange a **40-foot** Corinthian colonnade along a spline, reducing manual placement time by **95%** and enabling **rapid architectural iterations**.
- Developed a **multi-camera Blueprint system** for automating rendering of a **panoramic video** through ten perspectively correct **virtual cameras**, eliminating parallax distortion while maintaining **consistent lighting** and **exposure**.
- Created custom **Stable Diffusion pipelines** to **compose** 36 unique video segments, **style** with custom LoRA layers, **upscale** and **interpolate**, then **composite** in After Effects to achieve **visual coherence** across nine video panels in the installation.

➢ ***Shadows of Time*** *(documentation, video)* — 2024

- Architected an **immersive cinematic environment** in Unreal Engine, leveraging the Fab asset store and Sequencer to develop **59+** synchronized sequences across three **distinct lighting environments**.
- Executed **end-to-end** technical art workflows by modifying master materials for environmental consistency and orchestrating **custom animations withing Sequencer** to ensure high-fidelity visual storytelling.
- Managed the complete **cinematic lifecycle**, from world-building through final rendering, compositing, and color grading, resulting in a **high-quality video installation** exhibited at multiple international venues.

Optikka — **Remote**

Senior Software Consultant — August 2024 – January 2025

- Developed a new **javascript library** for responsive **html canvas** drawing, resulting in **80%** faster design iteration time through a systematic **row-column structure**.
- Proposed a migration plan to a **mono repo architecture** for javascript modules, which reduced development time by **50%** and improved **code maintainability** through standardized versioning.
- Eliminated **critical bottlenecks** in the **renderer**, to improve **performance** for drawing multi-layered html canvases at **scale**.

Microsoft Corporation — **Seattle, WA**

Software Engineer II (Skype) — April 2023 – July 2017

- One of the **founding engineers** for architecting and developing the next generation of Skype client for iOS & Android platforms, used by over 300 million monthly active users.
- Helped architect and **open-source a new cross-platform library** called ReactXP to a community of over **2000 developers** on Github and within Microsoft.
- Conducted user research, led the software architecture, and **coordinated with over 6 team leads,** to integrate a brand-new accessibility framework into Skype, which allowed Microsoft to ship the app.
- Led the integration of **chat bot services** into the app's user interface and created a **Machine-Learning driven** coffee bot, which was **showcased by the Vice-President of Skype** at Microsoft's Build Conference in 2016.

EDUCATION

MFA, Art & Technology Studies**,** School of the Art Institute of Chicago — 2017 - 2019

B.S, Computer Engineering, Virginia Tech — 2008 - 2012

- CGPA: 3.84/4.0, Rank 6/126, Dean's list with distinction (all 8 semesters)